

MySQL Setup & Import Guide

Installing MySQL Server & Workbench on Windows, and importing a database dump

Part 1: Installing MySQL on Windows

MySQL has two main components you need: **MySQL Server** (the actual database engine that stores and manages your data) and **MySQL Workbench** (a visual GUI for managing databases). Workbench alone cannot do anything without a running Server — they must be installed separately.

Note: The old bundled "MySQL Installer" that included everything in one package only supports up to MySQL 8.0. For MySQL 8.1 and newer, you must download and install Server and Workbench separately using their individual MSI installers.

Section A: Installing MySQL Server

Step 1 — Download MySQL Server

Go to the official MySQL Community Server download page:

<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/mysql/>

Use the dropdown to select your operating system (**Microsoft Windows**). Download the **MSI Installer** (not the ZIP archive). The filename will look something like:

```
mysql-9.x.x-winx64.msi
```

On the next page, you can skip creating an Oracle account — click "**No thanks, just start my download**" at the bottom.

Step 2 — Run the MSI Installer

Double-click the downloaded .msi file to launch the installer. If Windows asks to allow changes to your device, click **Yes**. Follow the setup wizard and accept the license agreement. The default installation settings are fine for local development.

Prerequisite: MySQL Server requires the **Microsoft Visual C++ 2019 Redistributable**. If you don't have it installed, download it from Microsoft's website before proceeding.

Step 3 — Run MySQL Configurator

After the MSI finishes, it will prompt you to launch **MySQL Configurator** — a tool that comes bundled with the Server MSI (for version 8.1+). This is where you set up the server. Accept the prompt and configure the following:

- **Config Type:** Development Computer
- **Connectivity:** TCP/IP, Port **3306** (leave as default)
- **Authentication:** Use Strong Password Encryption (recommended)

On the **Accounts and Roles** screen, set a **root password**. This is the master password for your database server — you will need it every time you connect.

Important: Write down your root password somewhere safe. If you forget it, resetting it is not straightforward.

Step 4 — Windows Service

Keep the default settings: **Configure MySQL Server as a Windows Service** should be checked, and **Start the MySQL Server at System Startup** should be checked. This means MySQL will automatically run whenever you start your computer. Click **Next**, then **Execute** to apply the configuration.

Step 5 — Verify the Server is Running

Open **Command Prompt** or **PowerShell** and run:

```
mysql -u root -p
```

Enter your root password. If you see the `mysql>` prompt, the server is installed and running. Type `EXIT;` to leave.

Note: If the `mysql` command is not recognized, you need to add MySQL to your system PATH. The default location is: `C:\Program Files\MySQL\MySQL Server 9.x\bin`

To add it: search **Environment Variables** in the Start menu → click **Environment Variables** → under System variables, select **Path** → click **Edit** → click **New** → paste the bin folder path → click **OK** on all windows. Then restart your terminal.

Section B: Installing MySQL Workbench

Step 1 — Download MySQL Workbench

Go to the official MySQL Workbench download page:

<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/workbench/>

Select your operating system (**Microsoft Windows**) and download the **MSI Installer**. Again, click **"No thanks, just start my download"** to skip creating an Oracle account.

Step 2 — Install Workbench

Double-click the downloaded .msi file and follow the installer wizard. The default settings are fine — just click through until it finishes.

Step 3 — Connect to Your Local Server

Open MySQL Workbench. You should see a connection tile on the home screen (usually labeled **"Local instance"** pointing to **127.0.0.1:3306**). Click it and enter your root password to connect.

If no connection tile exists, create one manually:

1. Click the **+** icon next to "MySQL Connections"
2. Set **Hostname** to **127.0.0.1**
3. Set **Port** to **3306**
4. Set **Username** to **root**
5. Click **Test Connection**, enter your password, and confirm it works
6. Click **OK** to save the connection

Part 2: Importing a MySQL Dump File

Now that MySQL Server and Workbench are installed, you can import the `.sql` dump file to replicate the database on your machine.

What You Need

- MySQL Server installed and running (see Part 1, Section A)
 - The `.sql` dump file (e.g., `users_dump.sql`)
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Method 1: Command Line (CLI)

Step 1 — Log into MySQL

Open your terminal and run:

```
mysql -u root -p
```

Enter your password when prompted.

Step 2 — Create a Database

Pick any name you'd like:

```
CREATE DATABASE your_database_name;
```

Then exit:

```
EXIT;
```

Step 3 — Import the Dump File

Back in your regular terminal (not the MySQL prompt), run:

```
mysql -u root -p your_database_name < C:\path\to\users_dump.sql
```

Replace the path with the actual location of your dump file.

Windows tip: Use backslashes in the path, or wrap the path in quotes if it contains spaces.
Example: `"C:\Users\YourName\Downloads\users_dump.sql"`

Step 4 — Verify

Log back into MySQL and check that everything imported correctly:

```
mysql -u root -p
```

Then run:

```
USE your_database_name;  
SHOW TABLES;  
DESCRIBE Users;
```

You should see the Users table with all its columns.

Method 2: MySQL Workbench

Step 1 — Connect to Your Local Server

Open MySQL Workbench and click your local connection tile (127.0.0.1:3306, user root). Enter your root password.

Step 2 — Create a Database

In the query editor, run:

```
CREATE DATABASE your_database_name;
```

Click the lightning bolt icon (or press Ctrl+Enter) to execute.

Step 3 — Select the Database

In the Schemas panel on the left, right-click and hit Refresh All. Your new database should appear. Double-click it to set it as the active schema (it will appear bold).

Alternatively, run:

```
USE your_database_name;
```

Step 4 — Import the Dump File

Option A — Using the query editor:

1. Go to **File** → **Open SQL Script...**
2. Navigate to your .sql dump file and open it.
3. Make sure your database is selected as the active schema.
4. Click the lightning bolt icon to execute the script.

Option B — Using the import wizard:

1. Go to **Server** → **Data Import**.
2. Select **Import from Self-Contained File**.

3. Browse to your `.sql` dump file.
4. Under **Default Target Schema**, select the database you created.
5. Click **Start Import**.

Step 5 — Verify

In the Schemas panel, right-click your database and hit Refresh All. Expand the Tables section — you should see the Users table. Right-click it and select Select Rows to confirm the structure is correct.

Notes

- The dump file is **not** tied to a specific database name — you can import it into any database.
 - If a Users table already exists in your target database, the import will **drop and replace** it.
 - If you get a GTID warning during import, it can be safely ignored for local development.
 - If the `mysql` command is not found on Windows, add the MySQL bin folder to your system PATH (see Part 1, Section A, Step 5).
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Useful Links

- MySQL Community Server download:
<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/mysql/>
- MySQL Workbench download:
<https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/workbench/>
- MySQL Documentation:
<https://dev.mysql.com/doc/>
- Visual C++ 2019 Redistributable (prerequisite):
[Microsoft Visual C++ Redistributable Downloads](#)